

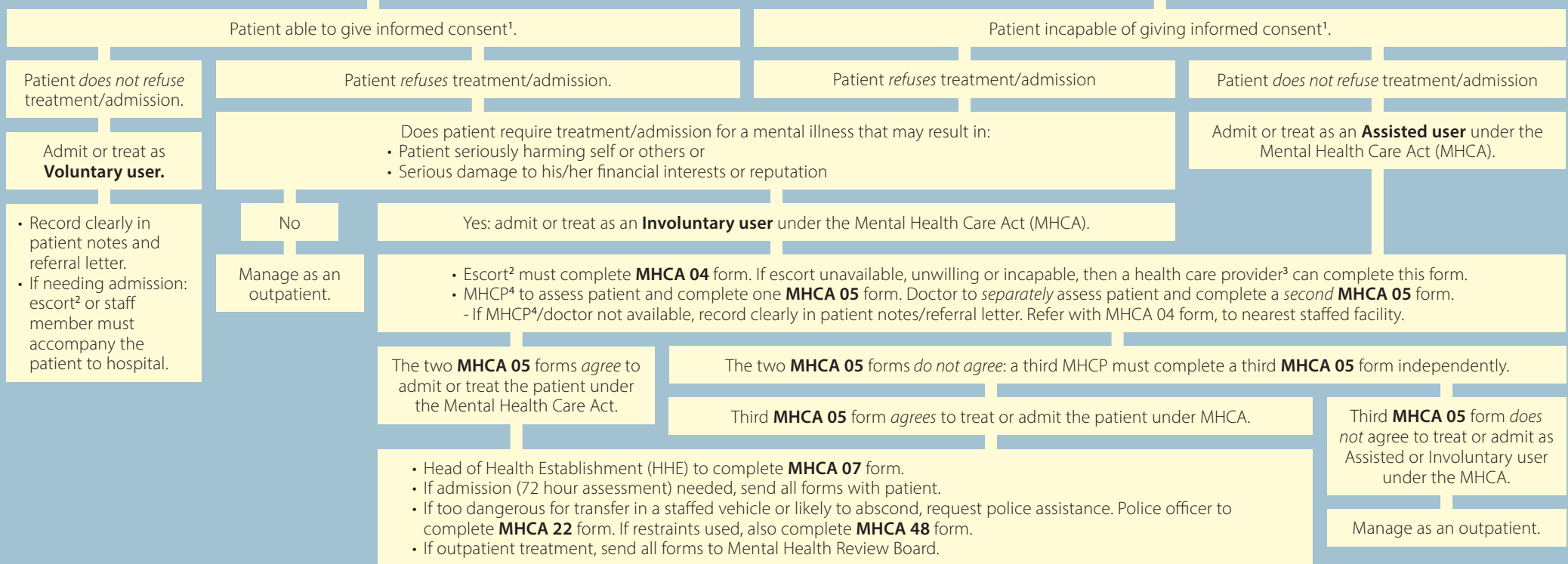
THE MENTALLY ILL PATIENT NEEDING TREATMENT OR ADMISSION

- Give urgent attention if a delay in referral may lead to the patient's mental illness causing any of:**
- Death
 - Irreversible health problem/s
 - Patient inflicting serious harm to self or others
 - Patient causing serious damage to or loss of property

Manage as an emergency and refer urgently with or without patient consent:

- If aggressive/disruptive ↪ 84. If restraints used, complete **MHCA 48** form.
- If patient is not alert, fully conscious or physically stable, check for underlying causes ↪ 85.
- Complete a **MHCA 01** form, **Emergency care, treatment and rehabilitation or admission without consent**, to admit for 24 hour assessment.
- If too dangerous for transfer in a staffed vehicle or likely to abscond, request police assistance. Police officer to complete **MHCA 22** form.

Approach to the mentally ill patient in need of hospital admission/treatment not needing emergency referral



The patient may present to primary care with **authorisation/order by a Court or Mental Health Review Board** to receive mental health care, treatment and rehabilitation on an outpatient basis: review patient and provide prescribed health intervention, regardless of patient consent. Record clearly in patient file. Report to Mental Health Review board as requested.

¹Informed consent means that patient understands that s/he is ill, needs treatment and can communicate his/her choice to receive treatment. ²Escort: if patient < 18 years old, this needs to be a parent or guardian; if patient ≥ 18 years old, escort can be spouse, next of kin, partner or associate. ³This can be *any* health care provider but needs to have observed patient's behaviour and must *not* be one of the mental health care practitioners who complete either of the MHCA 05 forms. ⁴Mental Health Care Practitioner.